

Homewise VOC Interview Notes #9

Before the interview (screener, done async or in first 2 min)

- Have you hired a contractor (plumber, electrician, HVAC, roofer, handyman, remodeler, etc. all count!) before?

Yes, I've hired electricians several times for home repairs and upgrades.

- Roughly what did the project cost? (A range is fine. Ideally, we want a mix: small repairs, bigger projects)

The projects ranged from a few hundred dollars for small electrical repairs to several thousand dollars for larger upgrades.

- Do you own your home?

Yes.

Warm-up

1. Tell me a bit about your home — how long have you owned it, and how often do you find yourself needing to hire someone for projects or repairs?

I've owned my home for several years. Since it's an older house, electrical issues and upgrades come up from time to time, especially when installing new appliances or improving lighting and outlets.

The Recent Experience

Anchor everything on one specific recent hire. Don't let them generalize.

2. Walk me through the **last time** you hired a contractor. Start from the moment you realized you needed one.

Recently, I noticed that part of the house would occasionally lose power when multiple appliances were running. I was worried it could be a wiring or breaker issue, so I decided to call an electrician.

3. How did you find them? What sources did you use? (Let them list — don't prompt.)

I searched Yelp and Google reviews and also asked neighbors for recommendations.

4. How did you decide which ones to contact? What made you rule some out?

I focused on electricians with strong reviews, fast response times, and clear communication. I ruled out companies that had poor reviews or refused to provide even rough pricing estimates.

5. How many quotes did you get? How did you compare them?

I contacted four electricians. I compared diagnostic fees, hourly rates, estimated repair costs, and customer reviews.

6. How did you know if the price was fair?

Honestly, it was difficult to tell. Electrical work pricing is not very transparent, and every company explained the issue differently. I mainly compared multiple quotes and online feedback.

7. What did you do (if anything) to check if they were licensed, insured, or reputable?

I checked their license online, reviewed ratings and customer comments, and confirmed that they were insured.

8. Walk me through scheduling and the actual work — how did that go?

Scheduling took longer than expected because many electricians were booked out. Once the electrician arrived, the repair process itself went smoothly and the issue was fixed the same day.

9. After the work was done, what happened with paperwork, receipts, warranties?

I received an invoice and receipt by email. They also gave me a short warranty for the repair work.

If you find someone trustworthy, would you hire them again?

Reliable electricians are hard to find, so once I trust someone, I prefer to continue using them.

Do you want to refer the contractor to someone else?

Yes. I often share good contractor recommendations with friends and neighbors.

Pain Point

10. What was the **most frustrating part** of that whole experience?

The most frustrating part was the lack of pricing transparency. I had to spend a lot of time calling different electricians, explaining the same problem repeatedly, and comparing inconsistent quotes. It was hard to know whether the pricing was reasonable.

11. If you could change one thing about hiring a contractor, what would it be?

I wish there were a platform where I could instantly compare electricians based on pricing, availability, licensing, and verified reviews without needing to make so many phone calls.

Current Workarounds & Prior Spending

12. Is there anything you do today to make hiring contractors easier — spreadsheets, apps, asking neighbors?

Mostly asking neighbors and checking online reviews. I also keep a small list of contractors I trust.

13. Have you ever paid for a service to help you find or vet contractors (Angi, Thumbtack, etc.)? What was that like?

I've browsed those platforms, but I still found it difficult to compare pricing clearly because many quotes were vague or changed after inspection.

Wrap-up

14. Looking back on that whole experience — finding, hiring, and working with the contractor — how would you describe it in a few words?

Time-consuming, stressful, and uncertain.

15. Is there anything about hiring contractors I didn't ask about that I should have?

You could ask more about pricing transparency, hidden costs, and how homeowners evaluate trustworthiness when they don't understand technical electrical work.

16. Do you know 1–2 other homeowners who've hired contractors recently who might be open to a similar chat?

Yes, I know a few homeowners in my neighborhood who recently hired electricians or other contractors and might be willing to share their experiences.